

Greetings from the Supervisor,

Lake Township has purchased two radar speed display signs. The hope is that the signs will encourage drivers to SLOW DOWN. In previous years, the Township contracted with the Sheriff's Office for a speed trailer and additional road patrol. Unfortunately, that is not an option this year due to staffing shortages at the County Sheriff's Department. The signs are portable and will be relocated based on need.

Drivers, as well as pedestrians and bicyclists, *please* pay attention and use caution while on the roads. Being diligent while on the water, as well as on the road, is so important. Please follow boating laws and any no-wake zone near shores and *always* watch for swimmers.

The Ironman bike route will again be traveling through Lake Township. The race is being held on September 20, 2026. The route is the same as in previous years. Road closures will be from approximately 9:00 am – 2:30 pm. Please plan accordingly. The route will be published in the paper and on the Township website as we get closer to race day. This is the last year that Ironman is currently under contract with the City of Frankfort.

The Lake Township Park at the mouth of the Platte River will be staffed seven days a week with attendants for the summer season. As Township residents, you are encouraged to enjoy the park at no charge.

Benzie, Grand Traverse, and Leelanau Counties are collaborating on a new materials management plan. The planning process is forward-looking, and we are exploring additional opportunities in addition to the current recycling program to encourage greater waste diversion from landfills. I am happy to be serving as the Township representative for the three-county area.

Please feel free contact me with any Township questions or concerns. I can be reached at the Township Office or at supervisor@laketwp.org

Mary Pitcher, Supervisor



Millage Reset

The Headlee Amendment to the Michigan Constitution was passed in 1978. This amendment requires local governments to lower property taxes if their aggregate property tax revenue goes up as the result of property values (and tax assessments) rising faster than inflation, unless voters approve the previous rate in a "Headlee rollback" election.

Benzie County and all of its townships operate under a fixed millage system, rather than an allocated millage system; a structure approved by voters in 1982 that also authorized a 5.29 millage for the County and 1.21 millage for each township.

Since that time the millage rates have been reduced due to the Headlee Amendment, resulting in a 2025 levy of 3.2399 mills for the County and .5243 mills for Lake Township

Because Benzie County's general operating millage is directly tied to all the township's millages, *the County cannot restore or change this funding source unless all the townships do the same.*

A Headlee Override — or "reset" — allows voters to restore the millage rates to their previously approved level. This does not create a new tax; it partially restores a rate that was already voted for in the past.

If a Headlee reset or operating millage restoration fails in 2026, the general operating revenue for both the county and its townships would be eliminated, placing numerous services at risk.

Potential Benzie County impacts include: reductions or elimination of Sheriff's Road Patrol Deputies, Animal Control, School Resource Officers, Drug Enforcement Programs, Parks and Recreation, and MSU Extension programs. In addition, residents could experience reduced public office hours, longer processing times for services, and deferred maintenance of buildings, technology, and vehicles, leading to declining infrastructure and higher future costs.

If approved Animal Control, School Resource Officers, and Drug Enforcement millages would be folded into the General Fund – eliminating those three separate millages (0.4074) mills) from your tax bill.

While Lake Township's Board of Trustees recognizes the need for this Headlee Override, or general operating millage reset at the County level, we are not anticipating any increase in the Township millage currently being levied.

from the TREASURER

Maryanne Goodman

There is a *major* change happening in the way the US Postal Service handles your tax payments. There will no longer be a postmark date showing when you actually mailed the envelope. Instead, the USPS postmark date will be at some undetermined point during their processing. Because I sometimes use these postmark dates to determine a payment date for your taxes, you will need to take that into consideration. Helpful options include mailing your payment earlier than previous years, or have the Post Office hand stamp the date on your envelope.

Example: Taxes due Sept 14

You mail payment Sept 12

USPS dates envelope Sept 15

Township receives payment Sept 17

Payment will be processed as Sept 15, considered late and any interest and/or penalties will apply.

Lake Township cannot be responsible for delayed postmark dates and will process payments according to the date on the envelope (if no postmark date is legible, we will use the date it was received in our office). I'm very sorry for this inconvenience, but we have no recourse and will not be able to make special exceptions. Please consider sending payment a week to ten days earlier than usual to avoid any late payment charges being assessed. There is also an on-line payment option for your property taxes available through our website. There is a small convenience fee (\$2 for ACH check, 2-3% for CC payments). Please be sure to check the service charge before okaying payment as they are not refundable.

ASSESSOR

Gunnar Brow, MAAO

The 2026 assessment cycle has started and I will be out performing inspections. These inspections are for the purpose of building, land use, health department, and short-term rental permits. I will be doing additional inspections based on the State Tax Commissions suggested 20% annual random sampling.

Personal Property Statements and exemptions must be postmarked by the date indicated on the form. Please keep in mind the changes to USPS postmark dates – it is no longer the date you mail the envelope, rather at a random date during their processing. To be sure of correct postmark date, consider having envelopes hand date-stamped by the Postal Service. Late filings will be returned and it will then be the responsibility of the property owner to file a petition with the March Board of Review.

Lake Township is in the process of updating their website, and typical forms related to the Assessing Department will be made available there. Also, please direct all address updates to the assessor's department. Address updates with the assessor are automatically updated with the treasurer. Address updates with any other entity are not automatically exchanged and can cause delays. All address updates should be sent to assessor@laketwp.org.

ELECTION TIME

Lake Township will be holding both an Open Primary and Gubernatorial Election in 2026.

Election Dates to remember:

PRIMARY ELECTION:

August 4, Tuesday; Election Day – Vote at the Township Hall 7am-8pm

Early Voting - Saturday, July 25 thru Sunday, Aug 2 at the Township Hall 8am-4pm

GENERAL ELECTION:

November 3, Tuesday; Election Day – Vote at the Township Hall 7am-8pm

Early Voting - Saturday, Oct 24 thru Sunday, Nov 1 at the Township Hall 8am-4pm

For all Absentee Voters, ballots will be sent to your most recent address on file.

BALLOTS CANNOT BE FORWARDED; so please check with the Clerk's office to be sure we have your correct address.

Township Residents may register to vote with the local clerk, online at [Vote.gov](https://www.vote.gov), or by mail using information at [Michigan.gov/sos](https://www.michigan.gov/sos).

CONSIDER BECOMING AN ELECTION INSPECTOR

It takes many dedicated people to help an election run smoothly. These people are called Election Inspectors. We are fortunate to have a great team that works the elections at Lake Township. However, we are always looking for more interested residents. If you would like to serve as an Election Inspector, please stop in at the Clerk's office to grab an application. You can have fun while assisting our Lake Township residents through the election process.

CHECKLIST

- ✓ Smoke Detectors
- ✓ Carbon Monoxide Detectors
- ✓ Inspect Chimney
- ✓ Clean Out Dryer Vents
- ✓ Update Mailing Address
- ✓ Shop Local
- ✓ Reduce/Reuse/Recycle
- ✓ Pull Garlic Mustard (May/June)
- ✓ Get Outdoors ☺

Garlic Mustard

Once again, the Grand Traverse Conservation District will be helping to fund a dumpster strictly for GARLIC MUSTARD disposal to be located at the Township Hall.

Please use sealed black plastic bags and place them inside the designated dumpster. This service will be available during May and June.

PLANNING & ZONING

-Mark Janeczko

The Planning Commission is in the process of updating the Lake Township Zoning Ordinance. The Township Board has recently approved two amendments to the current Zoning Ordinance. The first changes the definition of a structure to include docks and dockages (Article II Definitions). Second, to include a setback requirement of 10 ft. from side property lines as they extend into the lakes for all docks, dockages, and swim rafts; and that any dock lighting must be shielded or downfacing.

When you are setting up your dock, boats, and raft for the summer season, please adhere to the 10 ft setback from side property lines so everyone can enjoy the lakes.

You can keep up with all Lake Township Zoning on our website: www.laketwp.org.

As always, remember to shield, or better yet, turn off unnecessary outdoor lighting.

Burn Permits

Q: Can I burn today?

A: www.dnr.state.mi.us/burnpermits/
or call: 866-922-2876

BILL ROBINSON

July 13, 1928 - October 26, 2025

A Celebration of Life for long-time Lake Township Supervisor, Bill Robinson, will be held on July 11, 2026 from noon to 4:00pm at Elberta Waterfront Park.

Bill began his service with Lake Township in 1980 and served as our Township Supervisor for 35 years, from 1983 until his retirement in 2018.

All are invited to attend and honor Bill's life and legacy.



"Flowers always make people better, happier and more helpful; they are sunshine, food and medicine to the soul."

Many thanks to the Lakeshore Garden Club for keeping us in blooms all season long.

PARK NEWS

Lake Township Park continues to be as popular as ever, receiving thousands of visitors annually. From a quiet book read in the sun; to children playing in the lazy river; to family gatherings and picnics, Lake Township Park is a magnet for summer relaxation and fun.

We ask \$5.00 per day from visitors to use our parking lot and park facilities. Park use is free for residents with a Lake Township sticker affixed to their windshield.

NEW WINDOW STICKERS are included below. Please take a moment to carefully remove them. They should be placed on the lower passenger-side windshield of your vehicles.

Lake Township allows two stickers per resident property. If you have a large family or friends that visit the park frequently, please consider purchasing a season pass for \$40 that can be transferred between vehicles. They are available from Lake Township Park attendants, or the Township Hall.

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Benzie Contacts

Benzie County Visitors Bureau
visitbenzie.com

**Benzie County Chamber of
Commerce**
benzie.org

231 882-5801

**Frankfort-Elberta
Chamber of Commerce**
frankfort-elberta.com

231 352-7251

Benzie Bus
benziebus.com

231 325-3000

Benzonia Public Library
benzonialibrary.org

231 882-4111

Darcy Library of Beulah
darcylibraryofbeulah.org

231 882-4037

Benzie Shores District Library
benzieshoreslibrary.org

231 352-4671

**Sleeping Bear Dunes
National Lakeshore**
nps.gov/slbe

231 326-4700

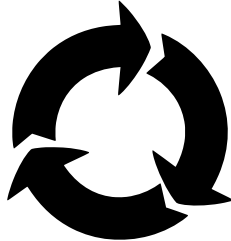
Point Betsie Lighthouse
pointbetsie.org

231 352-7644

Electronics Recycling

Electronic devices are not accepted at Lake Township's Clean-Up Day. This includes televisions, computers, cell phones, and other electronic equipment. Electronics should not be disposed of in landfills because they contain hazardous materials such as lead, mercury, and cadmium. When properly recycled, these materials can be recovered and reused.

Benzie County will host two electronics collection events this year, on June 20 and August 22. Additional details are available on the Materials Management page at benzieco.gov



SHRED IT

Lake Township will be hosting a shred day at the township hall on Friday, June 19, 2026 from 10am-1pm. Residents will be allowed to bring up to 10 boxes of loose paper to be shredded free of charge. Proof of residency will be needed. This event will be funded through the Lake Township General Fund. Only paper will be allowed, anything else will be turned away. Thank you for your cooperation.



GET INVOLVED

We are always looking for people interested in working and/or volunteering at Lake Township.

We hire park attendants for the summer season; and are always looking for residents to help run elections. Our clean up days are totally manned by volunteers.

In addition, we have several boards and committees that meet a handful of times each year. You can check the website for exact dates and times for all of the Lake Township meetings.

If you are interested in additional information on any of these positions, please contact the office by phone, mail, e-mail, or stop in during regular office hours.

9-1-1 SIGNS

Boy Scout Troop #10 continues to provide and install reflective green address signs for a fee of \$45. The signs are made of weatherproof heavy gauge aluminum and are secured on a 54" metal post. These signs are endorsed by all Benzie County Public Safety Services.

Order forms are available through the County Equalization website or at the Lake Township office.

LIFESAVING WATER SAFETY TIPS

AVOID DROWNING – BE CURRENT SMART

- **Know Before You Go** – Check the [National Weather Service](#) for forecasts about dangerous waves & currents.
- **Stay Dry When Waves Are High** – Whitewater/waves as little as 2-3 feet high can generate dangerous currents.
- **When in Doubt, Don't Go Out** – Respect the power of the water and don't take chances.
- **Buddy Up** – Never swim alone, there's safety in numbers.
- **Wear a Life Jacket** – Don't just bring it, wear it.
- **Steer Clear of the Pier** – Most current-related incidents occur near structures.

ESCAPE DROWNING – BE A SURVIVOR

- **Don't Fight the Current** – Even Olympic swimmers can't overcome the power of rip currents.
- **Yell for Help** – Call for help as soon as you realize you're in trouble – the closer you get to drowning, the harder it will be to yell.
- **FLIP, FLOAT & FOLLOW**
 - **Flip** – Flip over onto your back and stay calm.
 - **Float** – Float to keep your head above water and conserve energy.
 - **Follow** – Follow the safest path out of the water – swim to the side (parallel to shore) and if too tired to swim, keep floating.

SAFELY SAVE OTHERS FROM DROWNING – DON'T BECOME A VICTIM

- **Be a Water Watcher** – Designate someone to watch people in the water as their sole responsibility.
- **Drowning Doesn't Look Like Drowning** – Know the signs of drowning – it's not like Hollywood with lots of yelling and waving – it's actually subtle and silent.
- **Save Yourself First** – Don't become a victim trying to save someone else – only go out with a flotation device (e.g. life ring, kayak, surf/paddle board, cooler, soccer ball) and keep it between you and the victim; have someone call 911 to get more help on the way. Wear a life jacket if available.
- **PREACH, REACH, THROW, ROW** – Shout to the victim that help is on the way, try to reach them with a pole or rope, throw them a floatable, get to them on a board or in a boat/kayak/canoe.

NOTICE



LAKE TOWNSHIP CLEANUP DAYS



DATES: Saturday, June 13, 2026
Saturday, August 8, 2026
TIME: 8:00am – 12:00pm – *NO EARLY DROP-OFFS*
LOCATION: Lake Township Hall
M-22 & Lake Michigan Road (enter from the south driveway)

ITEMS NOT ACCEPTED

Automotive batteries and tires, any chemicals or hazardous waste, motor oil, paint, paint thinners and yard waste. Concrete, cement, refrigerators with Freon are also *not* accepted. No lumber over four feet in length. Recyclable items should be taken to the regular recycling sites (see the County Recycling details below). *No commercial or contractor dumping permitted.*

VOLUNTEERS WILL BE ON HAND TO ASSIST IN UNLOADING OF ITEMS

Please have small or loose items in bags or boxes. *All lumber must be under 4 feet in length.*
Lake Township reserves the right to refuse items for non-compliance.

****Contact the Township to Volunteer****

THIS SERVICE IS FINANCED THROUGH THE LAKE TOWNSHIP GENERAL FUND

COUNTY RECYCLING

Benzie County offers single stream recycling in seven locations throughout the County. Please be responsible by only recycling appropriate materials and never leaving items outside of the provided bins.

For all Benzie County recycling information, please visit benzieco.gov and click on *Community* and *Materials Management*, or contact Dave Schaffer at 231-882-0554 or 231-383-1579.